Recovering Accounting Judgment with AI: Textual and Non-Textual Experiments

Whose judgment do AI participants reproduce?

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Can AI recover accounting judgement?

- Accounting AI research tests information extraction, disclosure analysis, and answers to accounting questions.
- As models improve, conclusions about these capabilities change.

Can AI recover how financial-statement users respond to an accounting choice?

Does describing their knowledge and characteristics improve recovery?

Whose judgement is the benchmark?

Judgement evaluates evidence and assigns weight to it in reaching a decision. Training, knowledge, objectives, and attitudes toward uncertainty affect those weights.

Question	Benchmark
Factual question	An identified correct answer
Judgement	The response of a specified group

Standard setters need timely evidence before adopting a rule. Published experiments provide human benchmarks for recognition, measurement, presentation, and disclosure choices.

(Bonner and Lewis, 1990; Libby and Luft, 1993; FASB, 2025; Koonce et al., 2024)

Preview of results

- **Initial recovery:** GPT-6 recovers 39.8% of 236 human directions. Within presentation-based experiments, recovery is 64.7% for information changes and 31.0% for presentation-only changes.
- **Facts and judgement:** factual accuracy is 96.4% on 693 questions; human-direction recovery is 38.1% where all checks pass.
- **Participant descriptions:** knowledge raises recovery from 41.5% to 48.5% on 200 matched comparisons. Knowledge plus higher evidence thresholds adds 12.06 percentage points relative to neutral instructions.
- **Audience composition:** recovery is 41.9% under neutral instructions, 53.8% with equal risk-profile weights, and 55.4% with historical shares. Dated weights add 1.61 points beyond the equal mixture.
- **New tasks:** across 12 comparisons in two studies, recovery is 16.7% under neutral instructions, 25.0% with knowledge, and 33.3% with deliberate attention.

Accounting AI papers, 2024-2026



Koonce et al. (2024): papers by accounting standard

Conceptual framework

2006 Frederickson et al.
2009 Hewitt
2010 Hodge et al.
2010 Koonce et al.
2011 Koonce et al.
2012 Kadous et al.
2013 Libby & Brown
2014 Bonner et al.
2015 Anderson et al.
2015 Bloomfield et al.
2015 Hewitt et al.
2016 Kelton & Murthy
2016 Majors
2019 Cade et al.
2020 Doxey et al.
2021 Cascino et al.
2021 Young
2022 Barradale et al.
2022 Liu et al.
2023 Anderson

ASC 600: Revenue

2007 Clor-Proell & Nelson
2012 Bailey & Sawers
2017 Capps et al.
2021 Young

ASC 200: Presentation

1990 Marchant
1990 Mautz
1991 Cooper & Selto
1997 Maines et al.
1998 Hirst & Hopkins
2000 Maines & McDaniel
2001 Hronsky & Houghton
2004 Hirst et al.
2006 Bloomfield et al.
2008 Hodder et al.
2010 Elliott et al.
2010 Hodge et al.
2014 Clor-Proell et al.
2015 Elliott et al.
2015 Hewitt et al.
2015 Lachmann et al.
2017 Emett & Nelson
2019 Koonce et al.

ASC 700: Expenses

1991 Cooper & Selto
1992 Sami & Schwartz
1995 Cloyd
2001 Luft & Shields
2004 Hodge et al.
2006 Frederickson et al.
2009 Clor-Proell
2010 Seybert
2017 Emett & Nelson

ASC 300: Assets

1990 Marchant
1996 Cloyd et al.
1998 Hirst & Hopkins
2000 Hopkins et al.
2000 Maines & McDaniel
2001 Luft & Shields
2006 Bloomfield et al.
2008 Jackson
2009 Clor-Proell
2010 Elliott et al.
2010 Jackson et al.
2010 Seybert
2015 Elliott et al.
2015 Rennekamp et al.
2017 Asay et al.
2018 Tan & Trotman
2020 Kunz & Staehle

ASC 900: Industries

1997 Khumawala & Gordon
2001 Dietrich et al.
2003 Hirst et al.
2010 Koonce et al.
2021 Eilifsen et al.
2023 Anderson

ASC 400: Liabilities

1990 King et al.
1991 Davis et al.
1992 Reimers
1996 Hackenbrack & Nelson
1996 Hopkins
1998 Kennedy et al.
2006 Hodge et al.
2014 Clor-Proell & Maines
2015 Fanning et al.
2016 Clor-Proell et al.
2018 Kelton & Montague
2020 Du et al.

ASC 800: Transactions

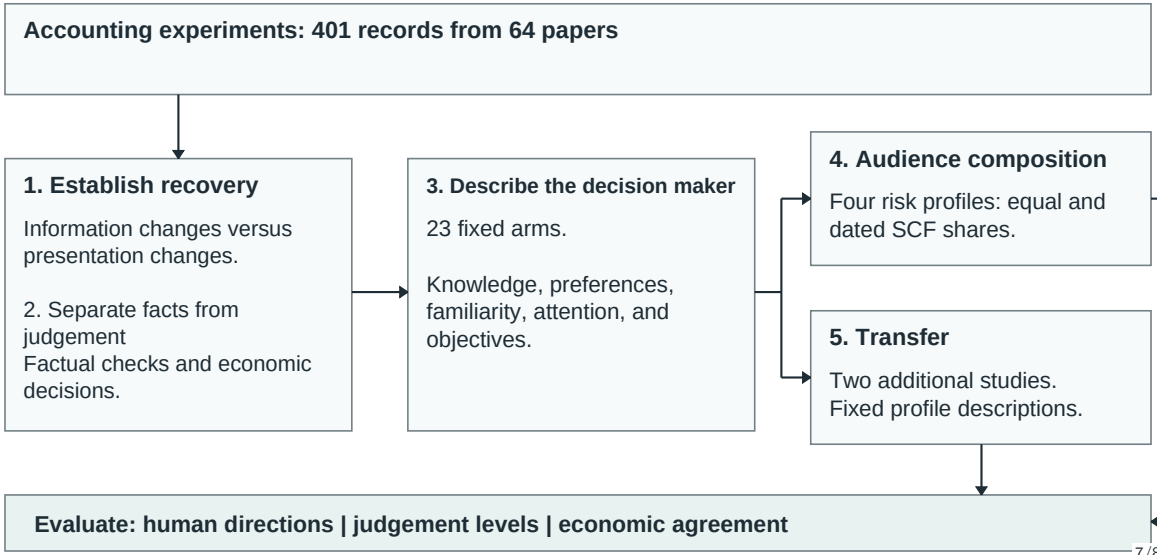
1995 Cloyd
1996 Hackenbrack & Nelson
2000 Hopkins et al.
2004 Hirst et al.
2005 Koonce et al.
2007 Nelson & Tayler
2010 Jackson et al.
2010 Jamal & Tan
2011 Agoglia et al.
2011 Gaynor et al.
2011 Koonce et al.
2012 Bailey & Sawers

ASC 800: Transactions (cont.)

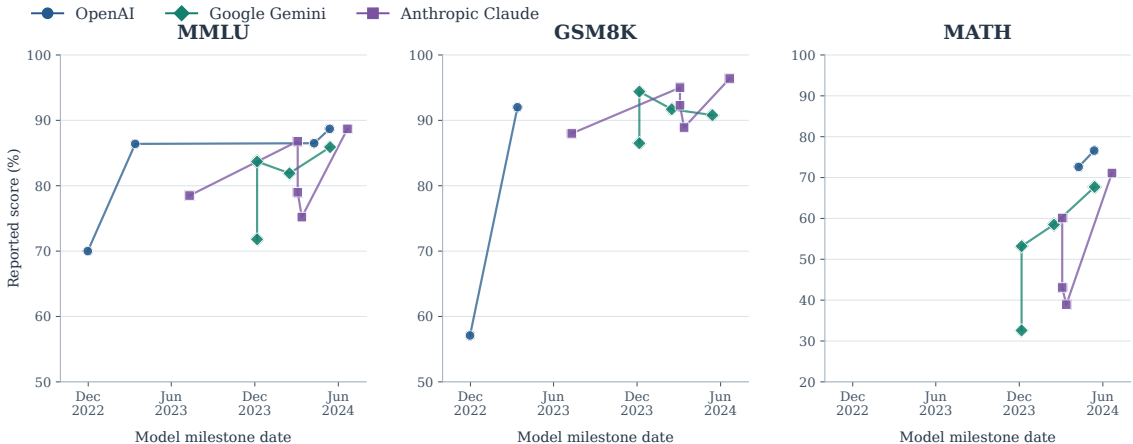
2012 Hales et al.
2012 Kadous et al.
2013 Chen et al.
2013 Cohen et al.
2014 Bonner et al.
2014 Clor-Proell et al.
2014 Griffin
2015 Anderson et al.
2015 Lachmann et al.
2015 Nelson & Rupar
2016 Majors
2019 He et al.
2019 Koonce et al.
2020 Doxey et al.
2020 Tan & Mayorga
2021 Chen et al.
2021 Eilifsen et al.
2022 Barradale et al.
2022 Liu et al.

Red: papers in our sample. Papers can appear under more than one standard.

Figure 1: Accounting judgement and audience composition



Model performance over time: knowledge and mathematics



OpenAI: GPT-3.5 → GPT-4 → GPT-4 Turbo → GPT-4o

Google Gemini: 1.0 Pro / Ultra → 1.5 Pro (February preview → May update)

Anthropic Claude: 2 → 3 Opus / Sonnet → 3 Haiku → 3.5 Sonnet

What is a judgement?

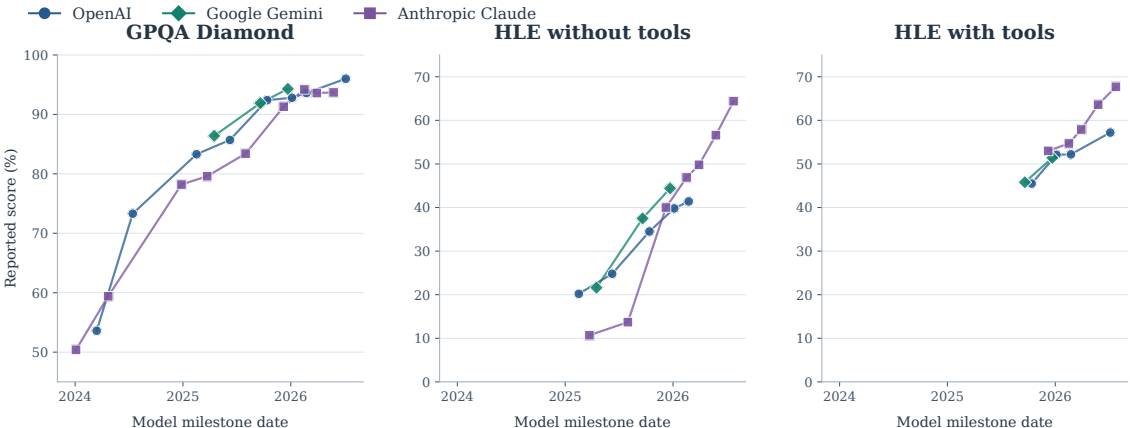
Judgement involves evaluating evidence and assigning weight to it in reaching an assessment or decision.

Evaluation	Meaning
Inaccuracy	A wrong amount, classification, or calculation against a defined answer.
Inconsistency	Departure from a specified decision rule or economic criterion, or a changed response under the same task.
Human recovery	Reproducing the response of the intended person or group to the reporting choice.

(Bonner and Lewis, 1990; Libby and Luft, 1993)

A judgment comparison requires a stated criterion and a specified decision maker.

Model performance over time: scientific and multidisciplinary reasoning



OpenAI: GPT-4o → o1-preview → o3 → GPT-5 → 5.2 → 5.4 → 5.5 → GPT-6 Astra

Google Gemini: 2.5 Pro → 3 Pro → 3.1 Pro

Anthropic Claude: 3 Opus → 3.5 Sonnet → 3.7 Sonnet → Opus 4 → Sonnet 4.5 → Opus 4.6 → 4.7 → 4.8 → 5 → 5.5

From academic questions to complete workflows

2019

- **Nov · ARC-AGI-1**
  Learning

2020

- **Sep · MMLU**
  Knowledge

2021

- **Mar · MATH**
  Mathematics
- **Jul · HumanEval**
  Software
- **Oct · GSM8K**
  Mathematics

2023

- **Jul · WebArena**
  Web / desktop
- **Oct · SWE-bench**
  Software
- **Nov · GPQA / Diamond**
  Knowledge
- **Nov · MMMU**
  Multimodal

2024

- **Apr · OSWorld**
  Web / desktop
- **Jun · MMLU-Pro**
  Knowledge
- **Jul · LAB-Bench**
  Science
- **Aug · SWE-bench Verified**
  Software
- **Sep · MMMU-Pro**
  Multimodal
- **Nov · FrontierMath**
  Mathematics

2025

- **Jan · Humanity's Last Exam**
  Knowledge
- **Mar · ARC-AGI-2**
  Learning
- **Apr · BrowseComp**
  Web / desktop
- **May · Terminal-Bench**
  Terminal
- **Sep · GDPval**
  Professional work
- **Nov · Terminal-Bench 2.0**
  Terminal

The widening benchmark landscape in 2026

Jan–Mar

- **Jan · FrontierMath Open Problems**
  Mathematics
- **Feb · LABBench2**
  Science
- **Mar · Riemann-bench**
  Mathematics
- **Mar · ARC-AGI-3**
  Learning

Apr–Jun

- **Apr · AutomationBench**
  Professional work
- **May · DeepSWE v1**
  Software
- **Jun · Agents' Last Exam**
  Professional work
- **Jun · FrontierMath Tier 4 v2**
  Mathematics
- **Jun · DeepSWE v1.1**
  Software
- **Jun · OSWorld 2.0**
  Web / desktop

Jul–Sep

- **Jul · AutomationBench v1.0.6**
  Professional work
- **Aug · Terminal-Bench-Science 0.1**
  Science
- **Aug · Terminal-Bench 4.0**
  Terminal
- **Sep · FrontierSWE v2**
  Software
- **Sep · OSWorld 2.1**
  Web / desktop
- **Sep · HLE-Diamond**
  Knowledge

October

- **Oct · Agents' Last Exam v1.1**
  Professional work
- **Oct · FrontierCode 2.0**
  Software
- **Oct · Artificial Analysis v5.0**
  Benchmark adoption

Increasing capability sharpens the judgement question

Reported benchmark score (%)	Earlier milestone	Later milestone
MMLU: GPT-3.5 to GPT-4o	70.0	**88.7**
GPQA Diamond: GPT-4o to GPT-6 Astra	53.6	**96.0**

These tests reward answers against a defined key. Accounting estimates and decisions also require a criterion for how evidence should be weighted.

Which criterion matters: the facts, an accounting rule, economic consistency, or the intended user's response?

We need a clear account of judgement before interpreting agreement or disagreement.

People sometimes change an answer to the same question

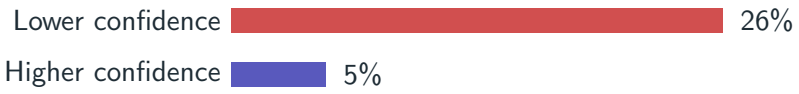
- Koriat (2008): 41 students answered 105 two-choice general-knowledge questions twice.
- After a short break, the same questions appeared in a new order.
- Participants repeated **83.4%** of their initial answers.

The implied average switching rate is **16.6%**.

Observed human responses include within-person variation.

Initial confidence predicts answer switching

Initial confidence	Repeat answer	Switch answer
Below own median	74%	**26%**
Above own median	95%	**5%**



Lower-confidence answers were substantially more likely to change.

A model of a person's judgment strategy

- Goldberg (1970) analyzed 29 clinical psychologists judging 861 MMPI profiles.
- For each psychologist, a linear model predicted that psychologist's rating from 11 MMPI scales.
- The fitted coefficients used the psychologist's judgments as the target.

Capturing a judgment policy and evaluating that policy are separate steps.

The model can outperform the person it approximates

Predictor	Correlation with recorded diagnosis
Psychologists	.28
Models of psychologists	**.31**

In split-sample cross-validation, models outperformed their corresponding psychologists in **86%** of comparisons.

Greater criterion accuracy can coexist with a departure from an individual's responses.

Benchmarks for evaluating a judgment

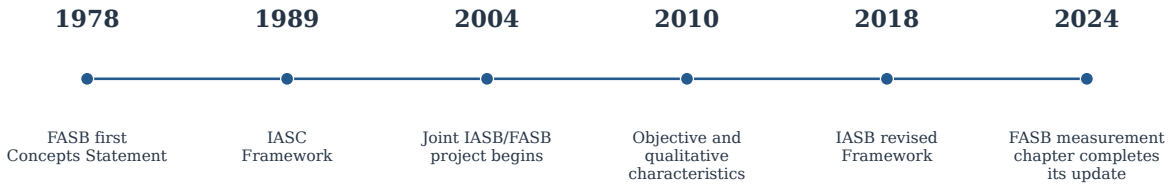
Outcome	Benchmark
Factual accuracy	The stated amount, classification, or calculation
Rule compliance	The governing accounting requirement
Economic consistency	A specified payoff, ordering, or economic criterion
Human recovery	The response of the intended person or group

Judgment comparisons require an explicit target and a specified decision maker.

OpenAI interaction style and behavioral changes



Development of the IASB and FASB frameworks



Source: Pelger (2016); Erb and Pelger (2015); IASB (2018); FASB (2024).

Useful information requires accounting judgement

Framework characteristic	Requirement
Relevance	Predictive or confirmatory value for decisions.
Faithful representation	Complete, neutral, and free from error.
Enhancing qualities	Comparability, verifiability, timeliness, understandability.
Cost constraint	Reporting benefits justify the costs.

(FASB, 2024), QC4–QC35.

Estimates incorporate future expectations and estimation error (Barth, 2006; Dechow and Dichev, 2002). Evaluating complex estimates requires integrating evidence (Griffith et al., 2015).

Accounting judgement applies reporting objectives to evidence, uncertainty, and informational trade-offs.

The development of benchmarks for tabular data



FinQA

Financial tables plus numerical programs

TAT-QA

Tables and narrative disclosures

TableBench preprint

General table reasoning and visualization

TableBench at AAAI

A broad table-reasoning benchmark

ToRR

Robustness across representations

TabArena

Prediction from structured features

ToRR revision

Updated representation tests

SpreadsheetBench 2

321 professional workbook tasks

Atomicity of tabular information

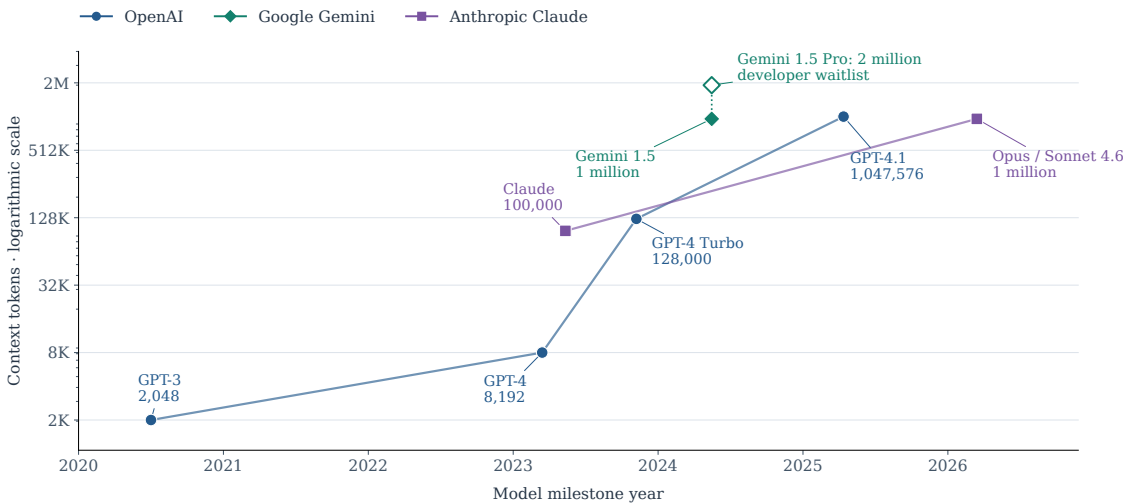
Kim, Kang, and Jung (2026) decompose table structure into six atomic features.

Atomic feature	Relationship conveyed
Grid formation	Which value occupies each row–column intersection.
Header designation	Which cells describe the data cells.
Cell merging	Which labels span rows or columns.
Header nesting	How categories form a hierarchy.
Section stacking	How sections share column structures.
Table composition	How different table structures fit together.

Source: (Kim et al., 2026).

An accounting amount must retain its relationships to periods, categories, and reporting sections.

The expansion of context-window capacity



Users bring knowledge and preferences to the same case

- Knowledge affects which classifications, relationships, and disclosures a user recognizes.
- Preferences affect how the user weighs uncertainty and decision consequences.
- A participant group combines people with different characteristics.

The target population becomes part of the experimental design.

Predictions for accounting judgements

H1: What does the reporting choice change?

Within presentation-based experiments, AI recovers human responses more often when the treatment changes information than when it changes presentation while holding information constant.

H2: Is correct processing sufficient?

AI and human judgements can differ even when AI correctly answers separate questions about the relevant accounting information.

The accounting treatment and the judgement criterion define the test.

Hirst et al. (2004): The accounting task

56 bank-specialist analysts and portfolio managers assess exposed or hedged banks under full fair value (FFV) or piecemeal fair value (PFV).

Exposed bank (millions)	20X1		20X2		20X3	
	NI	CI	NI	CI	NI	CI
FFV	16.7	15.3	18.6	20.1	20.3	**12.1**
PFV	16.7	16.4	18.6	18.9	20.3	16.7

Actual questions (1–15):

"Assess the investment risk of the bank's common stock relative to that of an average bank of equivalent size."

"Assess the investment risk of the bank's common stock in the context of a diversified portfolio."

(Hirst et al., 2004), Figure 1 and Table 1.

Hirst et al.: Predictions and human results

Normative predictions: the same bank receives the same risk judgment under FFV and PFV; the exposed bank is riskier under both.

Risk composite (1–15)	FFV	PFV	FFV − PFV
Exposed	**10.10**	**8.11**	+1.99
Hedged	6.68	6.94	−0.26

(Hirst et al., 2004), Table 1.

The human response to economic exposure is stronger when fair-value changes are recognized in income.

Koonce et al. (2005): The accounting task

90 MBA students assess three descriptions of economically equivalent positions. Each position produces fixed net interest payments.

Actual question: "Overall, how risky do you consider the company's [instrument]?"

Instrument wording	Net payments
Fixed interest-rate debt	Fixed
Variable-rate debt combined with a variable-to-fixed-interest-rate swap	Fixed
Variable-rate debt combined with a variable-to-fixed-interest-rate swap used as a hedge	Fixed

Risk is rated from 0 to 100, then rated again after cash-flow and fair-value exposure information.

(Koonce et al., 2005), Figure 1 and Table 1.

Koonce et al.: Predictions and human results

Predictions: initially, swap > fixed-rate debt and swap > hedge; exposure information should eliminate labeling effects.

Risk rating (0–100)	Before information	After information
Fixed-rate debt	**35.43**	39.17
Debt with a swap	**44.43**	43.83
Debt with a swap used as a hedge	37.17	34.60

(Koonce et al., 2005), Table 1.

Added exposure information did not eliminate the overall labeling pattern.

Hold the accounting case fixed; describe the decision maker

- Fix the source-defined role, treatments, questions, and response scale.
- Vary assigned knowledge, preferences, and other participant characteristics.
- Compare the same finding under neutral and profile instructions.

The profile describes who evaluates the evidence.

The source catalogue and the analytical samples

Analytical population	Count	Papers
Source catalogue: 401 accepted records	395	64
Source-compatible nonzero directions	208	47
Controlled procedure patterns	45	28
Unprofiled model-comparison panel	236	46
Exact-source human condition-mean vectors	69	20

The inventory contains 65 studies. Paired tests use the same available findings across the compared arms.

Each comparison uses its stated population and outcome.

The 23 arms describe alternative decision makers

Arm family	Arms	Description
Reference prompts	2	Original prompt; fresh neutral prompt
Assigned knowledge	1	Accounting expertise
Uncertainty and evidence	8	Cautious/open attitudes; higher/ordinary thresholds; with or without knowledge
Other characteristics	8	Horizons, familiarity, attention, objectives
Financial risk	4	SCF investment-risk categories

Primary profile model: GPT-6 Luna; temperature 0; reasoning disabled.

The 23 prompt arms are not population shares.

Four risk profiles define the audience mixture

Substantial risk; above-average risk; average risk; no financial risk.

$$\bar{y}_g(t) = \sum_{j=1}^{4} w_{gj} y_j(t), \qquad \sum_{j=1}^{4} w_{gj} = 1.$$

Audience mixture	Shares applied to the same four responses
Equal mixture	25% in each risk category
Dated audience	Closest preceding Survey of Consumer Finances wave
Fixed audience	2022 Survey of Consumer Finances distribution

Separate combining profile responses from changing their shares.

Directions, judgement levels, and economic decisions

Outcome	Evaluation criterion
Human recovery	Same sign as the source-compatible nonzero human contrast
Controlled pattern agreement	Source-defined pattern under the adapted task procedure
Judgement-level agreement	Distance from published human condition means
Economic agreement	Source-supported accounting rule or economic decision

Separate factual checks evaluate amounts, classifications, and relationships.

Agreement in direction need not imply agreement in level or decision quality.

Two additional accounting studies test transfer

Study	Initial decision task	Conditions
Le (2026)	Accounting rules and accounting-career judgements	3
Cai et al. (2026)	Cryptocurrency classification, measurement, and valuation	2

Apply all 23 fixed descriptions to the five initial decision screens.

These applications use the profile descriptions without audience weights.

(Le, 2026; Cai et al., 2026)

Transfer asks whether the participant description travels to a new accounting task.

The empirical sequence

1. Establish recovery on the accounting tasks.
2. Vary participant knowledge and characteristics.
3. Combine four risk-profile responses and vary their audience shares.
4. Assess judgement levels and the two additional accounting studies.
5. Examine robustness of the accounting comparisons.

The sequence moves from the accounting case to the decision maker and audience.

Table 1: Panel A: Source populations

Sample Construction and Analytical Coverage

Source population	Mappings	Findings	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel A. Source universe and analytical populations			
All accepted source mappings	401	395	64
Unprofiled model-comparison panel	236	236	46
Source-eligible nonzero judgments	208	208	47
All controlled patterns	45	45	28
Combined source patterns	253	253	49

Table 1: Panel B: Benchmark classes

Sample Construction and Analytical Coverage

Source population	Mappings	Findings	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel B. All source benchmark classes			
Scalar treatment comparisons	234	228	48
Joint or multivariate comparisons	22	22	11
Other scalar comparisons	68	68	27
Reconstructed numeric comparisons	32	32	27
Association comparisons	32	32	14
Distributional comparisons	8	8	4
Comparisons without a signed benchmark	3	3	2
Written-response comparisons	2	2	2

Table 1: Panel C: Analytical denominators

Sample Construction and Analytical Coverage

Analytical population	Findings	Papers
	(1)	(2)
Panel C. Analytical finding and paper denominators		
K versus N: source-eligible nonzero judgments	200	44
K versus N: controlled patterns	37	28
K versus N: combined source patterns	237	48
Four-arm mixture cohort: Human-direction agreement	186	39
Four-arm mixture cohort: Zero contrast	186	39
Four-arm mixture cohort: Reversed direction	186	39
Four-arm mixture cohort: Economic agreement	68	17
Exact-source complete human mean vectors: all sources	69	20
K versus N means: Normalized MAE	34	13
K versus N means: Like-unit improvement	60	19

Table 2: Panel A: Model contrasts

Baseline Recovery of Accounting Judgments

Panel A: Source-eligible model contrasts

	(1) Textual	(2) Presentation-based	(3) Inseparable	(4) Indeterminate	(5) All
Eligible scoreable findings	163	53	19	1	236
Source papers	36	14	8	1	46
Same direction as humans	66	23	5	0	94
Zero contrast	61	21	9	1	92
Opposite direction	36	9	5	0	50
Same direction (%)	40.5	43.4	26.3	0.0	39.8

Table 2: Panel B: Treatment channels

Baseline Recovery of Accounting Judgments

Panel B: Presentation-based minus textual regressions

Outcome	(1) Human direction recovered	(2) Zero contrast	(3) Reversed direction
Presentation-based treatment	2.91	2.20	−5.10
	(11.64)	(11.49)	(6.88)
Nominal p-value	0.804	0.849	0.462
Findings	216	216	216
Source papers	44	44	44
Intercept	X	X	X

Panel C: Information and Presentation Changes within Presentation-Based Materials

	(1) GPT-4.1	(2) GPT-4.1 mini	(3) GPT-5	(4) GPT-6	(5) GPT-6.1 Sol
Information changes: recovered/findings	14/17	11/17	9/17	11/17	11/17
Recovery (%)	82.4	64.7	52.9	64.7	64.7
Presentation changes holding information constant: recovered/findings	18/29	18/29	14/29	9/29	11/29
Recovery (%)	62.1	62.1	48.3	31.0	37.9
Difference (percentage points)	20.28	2.64	4.67	33.67*	26.77
	(15.11)	(20.44)	(15.37)	(18.99)	(16.86)
Nominal p-value	0.202	0.899	0.766	0.100	0.136
Findings	46	46	46	46	46
Source papers	14	14	14	14	14

Table 2: Panel D: Information-change regressions

Baseline Recovery of Accounting Judgments

Panel D: Information changes minus presentation changes holding information constant

Specification	(1) Unadjusted	(2) Channel and source controls	(3) Within paper	(4) Within source experiment
Information change	16.90**	12.46	5.66	15.62
	(8.23)	(10.09)	(13.45)	(17.62)
Holm-adjusted p-value	0.190	0.676	0.881	0.881
Findings	163	148	41	23
Source papers	36	35	6	4
Channel controls	–	X	–	–
Source and reconstruction controls	–	X	–	–
Paper FE	–	–	X	–
Source-experiment FE	–	–	–	X

Table 2: Panel E: Same-sample regressions

Baseline Recovery of Accounting Judgments

Panel E: Same-sample channel and information-content regressions			
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Information change	19.98**	18.68*	13.87
	(8.83)	(9.78)	(10.40)
Presentation-based treatment	8.86	8.88	9.34
	(10.47)	(10.25)	(9.02)
Additional source-finding indicator	–	X	X
Reconstructed or corrected-material indicator	–	–	X
Findings	154	154	154
Papers	34	34	34

Table 3: Panel A: Accounting-information checks

Accounting Information and Human Judgment

Panel A: Accounting-Information Checks

Question type	(1) Approved	(2) GPT-6 correct (% of approved)	(3) GPT-6.1 Sol correct (% of approved)
Identify an amount	237	234 (98.7)	230 (97.0)
Classify accounting information	235	227 (96.6)	223 (94.9)
Combine related information	221	207 (93.7)	209 (94.6)
Total	693	668 (96.4)	662 (95.5)

Panel B: Human Recovery after Correct Information Responses

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	GPT-6		GPT-6.1 Sol	
	All available checks pass	Three-type coverage	All available checks pass	Three-type coverage
Distinct directional findings	189	134	125	108
Source papers	44	35	35	30
Human direction recovered	72	47	52	45
Zero contrast	76	59	55	48
Reversed direction	41	28	18	15
Recovery (%)	38.1	35.1	41.6	41.7
Textual: recovered / findings	49/128	28/82	35/85	28/68
Presentation-based: recovered / findings	18/44	14/35	11/23	11/23
Presentation-based minus textual (percentage points)	2.63	5.85	6.65	6.65
	(12.57)	(15.07)	(14.19)	(15.20)

Table 4: Panel A: Authors· expectations

Human Responses and Economic Benchmarks

Panel A: Human findings and the authors' directional expectations

	(1) Textual	(2) Presentation-based	(3) Other	(4) All
Findings reviewed	164	53	20	237
Codable directional expectations	134	36	16	186
Human finding in expected direction	128	33	16	177
Agreement (%)	95.5	91.7	100.0	95.2
Null predictions	10	3	0	13
Other or unresolved expectations	20	14	4	38

Table 4: Panel B: Economic benchmarks

Human Responses and Economic Benchmarks

Panel B: Model agreement with source-supported benchmarks

	(1) GPT-4.1	(2) GPT-4.1 mini	(3) GPT-5	(4) GPT-6	(5) GPT-6.1 Sol
Eligible comparisons	45	45	45	45	45
Zero consistent with source invariance	15	13	20	23	23
Source-supported economic direction matched	0	0	0	1	5
Benchmark-consistent responses (%)	33.3	28.9	44.4	53.3	62.2
Human directions recovered	24	27	19	13	14
Human recovery (%)	53.3	60.0	42.2	28.9	31.1
Higher-confidence comparisons	28	28	28	28	28
Benchmark-consistent responses (%)	35.7	32.1	42.9	46.4	64.3
Equal-paper benchmark agreement (%)	38.7	32.1	32.0	53.1	52.9
Equal-paper human recovery (%)	54.2	62.2	54.6	34.6	29.8

Table 4: Panel C: Answers behind zero contrasts

Human Responses and Economic Benchmarks

Panel C: Answers Underlying Zero Treatment Contrasts

	(1) GPT-4.1	(2) GPT-4.1 mini	(3) GPT-6	(4) GPT-6.1 Sol
Recorded benchmark-consistent zeros reviewed	16	13	23	24
Correct economic action in relevant conditions	4	4	7	10
Same wrong substantive choice	4	0	0	0
Missing expressed economic response	0	0	2	0
Limited direction or rule correctness	2	0	3	3
Correct answer level not identified	5	9	11	10
Conditional endpoint ineligible or unverified	1	0	0	1
Diagnostic: different answers collapsed to a binary zero				
Source-defined binary collapse	3	0	1	0

Table 5: Knowledge versus neutral instructions

Accounting Knowledge and Human-Judgment Recovery

Source definition	Outcome	Source N	K minus N (pp)	Paired N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Source-eligible nonzero judgments	Human direction	207	7.00 (6.76)	200	44	X
Source-correspondence sensitivity	Human direction	205	7.07 (6.83)	198	43	X
Controlled numeric reconstructions	Source pattern	31	-9.68 (10.09)	31	26	X
Controlled patterns: other adaptations	Source pattern	13	0.00 (0.00)	6	3	X
All controlled patterns	Source pattern	44	-8.11 (8.11)	37	28	X
Combined source patterns	Source pattern	251	4.64 (5.74)	237	48	X

Table 6: Knowledge and uncertainty attitudes

Participant Profiles and Knowledge Interactions

Assigned description	Direction	Zero	Reversal	N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Assigned knowledge						
Strong assigned knowledge	7.00 (6.76)	-6.00 (5.19)	-1.00 (5.36)	200	44	X
Uncertainty preference						
Cautious preference	3.52 (6.46)	-7.04 (6.42)	3.52 (6.20)	199	43	X
Opportunity-open preference	4.50 (5.69)	-6.00 (5.62)	1.50 (4.07)	200	43	X
Cautious + knowledge	1.04 (7.12)	-7.25 (6.89)	6.22 (6.78)	193	43	X
Opportunity-open + knowledge	3.98 (5.46)	-6.97 (6.57)	2.99 (5.56)	201	44	X

Table 6: Evidence thresholds and horizon

Participant Profiles and Knowledge Interactions

Assigned description	Direction	Zero	Reversal	N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Evidence threshold						
	9.05	-5.03	-4.02			
Higher evidence threshold	(6.45)	(7.14)	(6.01)	199	43	X
	3.00	-4.50	1.50			
Ordinary evidence threshold	(6.14)	(4.87)	(5.93)	200	44	X
	12.06	-8.54	-3.52			
Higher threshold + knowledge	(5.84)	(5.76)	(4.98)	199	43	X
	7.58	-8.08	0.51			
Ordinary threshold + knowledge	(7.10)	(5.66)	(5.73)	198	44	X
Investment horizon						
	4.46	-4.46	0.00			
Nearer investment horizon	(5.65)	(6.46)	(3.88)	202	44	X
	4.98	-4.48	-0.50			
Longer investment horizon	(4.80)	(5.37)	(4.67)	201	44	X

Table 6: Familiarity, attention, and objectives

Participant Profiles and Knowledge Interactions

Assigned description	Direction	Zero	Reversal	N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Task familiarity						
Routine task familiarity	4.48 (5.88)	-3.98 (5.08)	-0.50 (4.89)	201	44	X
Extensive task familiarity	0.50 (5.12)	-4.50 (5.18)	4.00 (5.42)	200	44	X
Processing attention						
Deliberative attention	4.00 (5.81)	-6.00 (5.04)	2.00 (4.17)	200	44	X
Efficient attention	3.50 (5.15)	-5.50 (5.00)	2.00 (4.73)	200	44	X
Decision objective						
Stewardship objective	2.50 (3.19)	0.50 (3.13)	-3.00 (2.98)	200	43	X
Valuation objective	0.52 (2.88)	-0.52 (3.07)	0.00 (3.17)	192	43	X

Table 6: Financial-risk descriptions

Participant Profiles and Knowledge Interactions

Assigned description	Direction	Zero	Reversal	N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Financial risk willingness						
Substantial financial risk	2.50 (5.03)	-2.50 (5.13)	0.00 (2.86)	200	44	X
Above-average financial risk	4.50 (5.73)	-2.00 (5.30)	-2.50 (3.98)	200	44	X
Average financial risk	2.97 (5.33)	0.50 (5.98)	-3.47 (4.94)	202	44	X

Table 6: No-risk description and knowledge interactions

Participant Profiles and Knowledge Interactions

Assigned description	Direction	Zero	Reversal	N	Papers	FE
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
No financial risk	-5.50 (5.77)	7.00 (6.32)	-1.50 (4.25)	200	43	X
Planned balanced knowledge interactions						
Knowledge: cautious minus opportunity-open	-0.52 (5.47)	0.00 (4.63)	0.52 (4.09)	193	43	—
Knowledge: higher minus ordinary threshold	-2.02 (6.88)	1.01 (6.39)	1.01 (5.17)	198	43	—

Table 7: Human recovery and zero contrasts

Recovery and Economic Agreement across Risk-Profile Mixtures

Arm	Events	Findings	Papers	Equal-finding %	Equal-paper %
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Human-direction agreement					
Neutral prompt (N)	78	186	39	41.94	44.97
Equal four-risk mixture	100	186	39	53.76	56.14
Historical population mixture	103	186	39	55.38	58.39
Fixed-2022 population mixture	105	186	39	56.45	59.52
Zero contrast					
Neutral prompt (N)	75	186	39	40.32	36.57
Equal four-risk mixture	47	186	39	25.27	23.34
Historical population mixture	44	186	39	23.66	21.26
Fixed-2022 population mixture	44	186	39	23.66	21.26

Table 7: Reversals and economic agreement

Recovery and Economic Agreement across Risk-Profile Mixtures

Arm	Events	Findings	Papers	Equal-finding %	Equal-paper %
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Reversed direction					
Neutral prompt (N)	33	186	39	17.74	18.47
Equal four-risk mixture	39	186	39	20.97	20.52
Historical population mixture	39	186	39	20.97	20.35
Fixed-2022 population mixture	37	186	39	19.89	19.21
Economic agreement					
Neutral prompt (N)	44	68	17	64.71	60.85
Equal four-risk mixture	42	68	17	61.76	58.80
Historical population mixture	41	68	17	60.29	52.91
Fixed-2022 population mixture	40	68	17	58.82	51.93

Table 8: Panel A: Equal finding weights (1/2)

Risk-Profile Mixtures and Audience Composition

Signed comparison	Recovery (pp)	Zero (pp)	Reversal (pp)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Historical population mixture minus N	13.44*	-16.67	3.23
	(5.43)	(6.95)	(4.32)
Equal four-risk mixture minus N	11.83	-15.05	3.23
	(5.48)	(7.22)	(4.32)
Historical population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	1.61	-1.61	0.00
	(1.69)	(1.30)	(1.54)

Table 8: Panel A: Equal finding weights (2/2)

Risk-Profile Mixtures and Audience Composition

Signed comparison	Recovery (pp)	Zero (pp)	Reversal (pp)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus N	14.52*	-16.67	2.15
	(5.58)	(6.95)	(4.66)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Historical population mixture	1.08	0.00	-1.08
	(1.06)	(0.00)	(1.06)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	2.69	-1.61	-1.08
	(2.23)	(1.30)	(2.16)
Identical six-comparison support, separately by endpoint			
Paired findings	186	186	186
Papers	39	39	39
Holm-family size	6	6	6

Table 8: Panel B: Equal paper weights (1/2)

Risk-Profile Mixtures and Audience Composition

Signed comparison	Recovery (pp)	Zero (pp)	Reversal (pp)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Historical population mixture minus N	13.42*	-15.31*	1.89
	(5.01)	(5.96)	(4.33)
Equal four-risk mixture minus N	11.18*	-13.23	2.06
	(4.76)	(5.99)	(3.93)
Historical population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	2.24	-2.08	-0.17
	(2.46)	(1.95)	(1.68)

Table 8: Panel B: Equal paper weights (2/2)

Risk-Profile Mixtures and Audience Composition

Signed comparison	Recovery (pp)	Zero (pp)	Reversal (pp)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus N	14.56*	-15.31*	0.75
	(5.58)	(5.96)	(5.13)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Historical population mixture	1.14	0.00	-1.14
	(1.27)	(0.00)	(1.27)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	3.38	-2.08	-1.31
	(3.22)	(1.95)	(2.72)
Identical six-comparison support, separately by endpoint			
Paired findings	186	186	186
Papers	39	39	39
Holm-family size	6	6	6

Table 9: Panel A: Normalized MAE (1/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Strong assigned knowledge	0.021	0.020		
	(0.031)	(0.025)	34	13
Cautious preference	0.003	0.003		
	(0.027)	(0.030)	34	13
Opportunity-open preference	0.004	-0.004		
	(0.018)	(0.018)	34	13
Cautious + knowledge	0.056	0.050		
	(0.038)	(0.035)	30	12
Opportunity-open + knowledge	0.040	0.041		
	(0.023)	(0.021)	34	13
Higher evidence threshold	-0.025	-0.027		
	(0.024)	(0.025)	34	13
Ordinary evidence threshold	0.013	0.015		
	(0.032)	(0.030)	34	13

Table 9: Panel A: Normalized MAE (2/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Higher threshold + knowledge	-0.015 (0.019)	-0.010 (0.019)	34	13
Ordinary threshold + knowledge	-0.001 (0.030)	0.005 (0.026)	34	13
Nearer investment horizon	0.011 (0.029)	0.008 (0.027)	34	13
Longer investment horizon	0.008 (0.020)	0.010 (0.018)	34	13
Routine task familiarity	0.015 (0.025)	0.015 (0.023)	34	13
Extensive task familiarity	-0.007 (0.026)	-0.006 (0.024)	34	13
Deliberative attention	-9.51×10^{-5} (0.023)	-0.001 (0.022)	34	13

Table 9: Panel A: Normalized MAE (3/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Efficient attention	-0.027 (0.041)	-0.027 (0.035)	34	13
Stewardship objective	0.009 (0.024)	0.016 (0.026)	34	13
Valuation objective	0.010 (0.022)	0.005 (0.020)	34	13
Substantial financial risk	-0.007 (0.031)	-0.001 (0.030)	34	13
Above-average financial risk	-0.019 (0.062)	-0.015 (0.054)	34	13
Average financial risk	-0.046 (0.053)	-0.041 (0.047)	34	13
No financial risk	0.043 (0.033)	0.052 (0.044)	34	13

Table 9: Panel B: Like-unit improvement (1/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Strong assigned knowledge	0.017 (0.208)	0.003 (0.211)	60	19
Cautious preference	0.000 (0.255)	0.125 (0.253)	59	18
Opportunity-open preference	0.186 (0.186)	0.216 (0.194)	59	18
Cautious + knowledge	-0.309 (0.245)	-0.231 (0.250)	55	17
Opportunity-open + knowledge	-0.283 (0.201)	-0.274 (0.230)	60	19
Higher evidence threshold	0.276 (0.208)	0.270 (0.242)	58	18
Ordinary evidence threshold	-0.067 (0.194)	-0.127 (0.228)	60	19

Table 9: Panel B: Like-unit improvement (2/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Higher threshold + knowledge	0.071 (0.189)	0.037 (0.244)	56	17
Ordinary threshold + knowledge	-0.033 (0.227)	0.003 (0.243)	60	19
Nearer investment horizon	0.017 (0.167)	0.070 (0.196)	60	19
Longer investment horizon	0.150 (0.144)	0.132 (0.178)	60	19
Routine task familiarity	-0.017 (0.186)	-0.015 (0.201)	60	19
Extensive task familiarity	0.083 (0.231)	0.089 (0.254)	60	19
Deliberative attention	0.083 (0.198)	0.161 (0.214)	60	19

Table 9: Panel B: Like-unit improvement (3/3)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Assigned description	Equal findings	Equal papers	N	Papers
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Efficient attention	0.200 (0.173)	0.275 (0.184)	60	19
Stewardship objective	-0.034 (0.152)	-0.059 (0.169)	59	18
Valuation objective	-0.102 (0.130)	-0.004 (0.176)	59	18
Substantial financial risk	-0.050 (0.134)	-0.091 (0.182)	60	19
Above-average financial risk	-0.067 (0.140)	0.014 (0.184)	60	19
Average financial risk	0.283 (0.161)	0.309 (0.183)	60	19
No financial risk	-0.136 (0.129)	-0.154 (0.177)	59	18

Table 9: Panel C: Equal finding weights (1/2)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Signed comparison	Normalized MAE	Like-unit improvement
	(1)	(2)
Equal finding weights		
Historical population mixture minus N	-0.051	0.302
	(0.054)	(0.224)
Equal four-risk mixture minus N	-0.044	0.208
	(0.056)	(0.214)
Historical population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	-0.007	0.113
	(0.006)	(0.177)

Table 9: Panel C: Equal finding weights (2/2)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Signed comparison	Normalized MAE	Like-unit improvement
	(1)	(2)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus N	-0.050 (0.056)	0.264 (0.220)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Historical population mixture	0.001 (0.005)	0.000 (0.251)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	-0.006 (0.009)	0.151 (0.182)
Identical six-comparison support, separately by endpoint		
Paired findings	32	53
Papers	12	16
Holm-family size	6	6

Table 9: Panel C: Equal paper weights (1/2)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Signed comparison	Normalized MAE	Like-unit improvement
	(1)	(2)
Equal paper weights		
Historical population mixture minus N	-0.053 (0.048)	0.358 (0.232)
Equal four-risk mixture minus N	-0.043 (0.049)	0.244 (0.222)
Historical population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	-0.009 (0.007)	0.204 (0.239)

Table 9: Panel C: Equal paper weights (2/2)

Agreement with Human Judgment Levels

Signed comparison	Normalized MAE	Like-unit improvement
	(1)	(2)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus N	-0.051 (0.049)	0.296 (0.226)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Historical population mixture	0.001 (0.005)	0.037 (0.265)
Fixed-2022 population mixture minus Equal four-risk mixture	-0.008 (0.010)	0.225 (0.235)
Identical six-comparison support, separately by endpoint		
Paired findings	32	53
Papers	12	16
Holm-family size	6	6

Table 10: Le: Reference prompts, knowledge, uncertainty

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Original prompt			
Original prompt (B)	3/11	27.27	0.167
Neutral control			
Neutral prompt (N)	2/11	18.18	0.240
Assigned knowledge			
Strong assigned knowledge	3/11	27.27	0.208
Uncertainty preference			
Cautious preference†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Opportunity-open preference†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Cautious + knowledge†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Opportunity-open + knowledge†	2/11	18.18	0.240

Table 10: Le: Evidence, horizon, and familiarity

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Evidence threshold			
Higher evidence threshold†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Ordinary evidence threshold†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Higher threshold + knowledge†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Ordinary threshold + knowledge†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Investment horizon			
Nearer investment horizon†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Longer investment horizon†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Task familiarity			
Routine task familiarity	2/11	18.18	0.058
Extensive task familiarity	2/11	18.18	0.195

Table 10: Le: Attention, objectives, and risk

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Processing attention			
Deliberative attention	4/11	36.36	0.163
Efficient attention	3/11	27.27	0.216
Decision objective			
Stewardship objective†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Valuation objective†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Financial risk willingness			
Substantial financial risk†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Above-average financial risk†	2/11	18.18	0.240
Average financial risk†	2/11	18.18	0.240
No financial risk†	2/11	18.18	0.240

Table 10: Cai: Reference prompts, knowledge, uncertainty

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Original prompt			
Original prompt (B)	0/1	0.00	0.023
Neutral control			
Neutral prompt (N)	0/1	0.00	0.123
Assigned knowledge			
Strong assigned knowledge	0/1	0.00	0.023
Uncertainty preference			
Cautious preference	0/1	0.00	0.023
Opportunity-open preference	0/1	0.00	0.123
Cautious + knowledge	0/1	0.00	0.023
Opportunity-open + knowledge	0/1	0.00	0.023

Table 10: Cai: Evidence thresholds and horizon

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Evidence threshold			
Higher evidence threshold	0/1	0.00	0.023
Ordinary evidence threshold	0/1	0.00	0.023
Higher threshold + knowledge	0/1	0.00	0.023
Ordinary threshold + knowledge	0/1	0.00	0.023
Investment horizon			
Nearer investment horizon†	0/1	0.00	0.123
Longer investment horizon†	0/1	0.00	0.123

Table 10: Cai: Familiarity and attention

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Task familiarity			
Routine task familiarity	0/1	0.00	0.223
Extensive task familiarity	0/1	0.00	0.023
Processing attention			
Deliberative attention	0/1	0.00	0.023
Efficient attention	0/1	0.00	0.023

Table 10: Cai: Objectives and financial risk

Participant Profiles in Two Additional Accounting Studies

Assigned description	Agreement / scored	Agreement %	Normalized effect error
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Decision objective			
Stewardship objective†	0/1	0.00	0.123
Valuation objective†	0/1	0.00	0.123
Financial risk willingness			
Substantial financial risk	0/1	0.00	0.123
Above-average financial risk	0/1	0.00	0.123
Average financial risk	0/1	0.00	0.023
No financial risk	0/1	0.00	0.023

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